

Story 3: Defining Interaction Between User and Chatbot (stories.yml)

1. Introduction

After defining intents and responses, the next critical step in chatbot development is designing the conversational flow. This is achieved using the **stories.yml** file in Rasa. The stories file acts as a blueprint that teaches the chatbot how to respond to users in a structured and context-aware manner.

2. Purpose of stories.yml

The **stories.yml** file contains example conversations between the user and the chatbot. These conversations, known as stories, demonstrate how different user intents should be handled by the chatbot through appropriate actions and responses. By learning from these examples, Rasa Core is able to predict the next best action during a real conversation.

3. Structure of a Story

Each story is composed of a logical sequence of steps that represent a real interaction scenario. The structure typically includes:

- A user intent that represents what the user wants to say.
- A corresponding bot action, such as responding with a message or performing a task.
- Optional follow-up interactions to maintain conversational flow and context.

4. Example Interaction Flow

For example, when a user requests a motivational quote, the chatbot identifies the intent and responds with an appropriate quote. To enhance user engagement, the chatbot may also ask a follow-up question, such as whether the user found the quote helpful. This allows the chatbot to handle conversations in a more natural and human-like manner.

5. Importance of Defining Stories

Defining interaction patterns using stories ensures that the chatbot behaves logically rather than randomly. It helps maintain context, improves response accuracy, and provides a smooth conversational experience. Well-defined stories enable the chatbot to understand user expectations and respond consistently across different scenarios.

6. Outcome

By implementing structured stories in the **stories.yml** file, the chatbot follows a meaningful conversation flow. This step is essential for building a reliable, user-friendly, and intelligent quote recommendation chatbot that performs effectively in real-world interactions.